

SHOGUN METHOD X

Deploying Shogun Method for Power,
Influence & Social Preeminence

AKIRA ANZAI & DEREK RAKE

SHOGUNMETHOD
PRESS

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For our ancestors, spiritual and intellectual—
Grácian, Hobbes, Rousseau, Machiavelli,
Guicciardini

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“None are more hopelessly
enslaved than those who
falsely believe they are free.”

Johann Wolfgang von Goethe

PREFACE



confession is in order. Except for this short preface, I wrote nothing in this book.

Akira Anzai wrote *everything*.

So, why I am claiming co-authorship then?

Simple.

As a Shogun, Akira Anzai is a man bound by his integrity. Consistent to character, he gave credit to Shogun Method as any honorable man would. After all, Shogun Method **X** is the *extension* of Shogun Method into the realm of social power. There is no Shogun Method X if Shogun Method does not exist.

Now, here's the thing, though. I may be the grandmaster of the dark arts of emotional enslavement, but when it comes to influence and social preeminence, I defer to Akira.

I could spin a yarn about the legendary origins of Akira Anzai and how he led the swashbuckler's life as consigliere to moguls, vizier to modern day kings. But I won't, simply because I want his work to stand on its own. And that he is the only man I've ever shared co-author credits with should assure you of his legitimacy.

DEREK RAKE

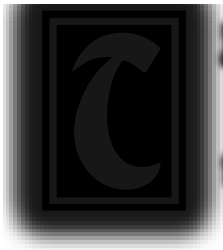
SHOGUN METHOD



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CHAPTER I

FRACTIONATION I: FRACTALITY



**here is a monstrous misconception among
the adherents of mainstream persuasion, and
it's this—**

“Let the mark shine.”

This is a horrible mistake.

You've already seen this in Shogun Method. To a woman, being nice, passive and accommodating is *anti-sexy*. It's natural to think that doing nice things for a woman will pull her to you. The opposite, in fact, is true.

Those who operate on the other end of the scale suffer the same consequence. Imperious men who exert their aggressive will on others wonder why women stay away from them.

Shogun Method involves the process of swinging back-and-forth between the two extremes. Alpha and beta. Passive and aggressive. Peaks and troughs. Joy and sorrow.

In the Shogun Method world, we call this oscillatory process *Fractionation*.

FRACTIONATION IN PERSUASION

Like attraction, persuasion follows a similar pattern.

A mark is never persuaded by a wimp. Again, it's natural, or even intuitive, to think you'll make someone like you by playing the Mr Nice Guy. Always be pleasing to your mark makes you look like a schmuck. Flattery could generate intrigue but is impotent as a compliance device.

Nobody respects a Yes Man. And yet if you come on too strong, you're unlikeable. Rapport precedes compliance; you cannot persuade someone who actively dislikes you. You can be an asshole and still be persuasive if people like you. The problem arises when you're a *hated* asshole.

The solution? Again, it's about finding the sweet spot between the two extremes. Be nice and accommodating one day, only to turn into an insufferable tyrant the next. Persuasion dies when your mark pigeonholes you, thinking he has got you figured out.

Like to a woman, you want to keep your mark on his toes. Confine him inside a state of intrigue and confusion. And the way to do this is by the measured oscillation between good and bad, positive and negative, nice and nasty. *Fractionation.*

THE FRACTAL NATURE OF FRACTIONATION

Fractionation is *fractal*.

What does that mean?

Fractality is a never-ending pattern where a small component looks like the whole. It repeats itself on different scales of the same object.

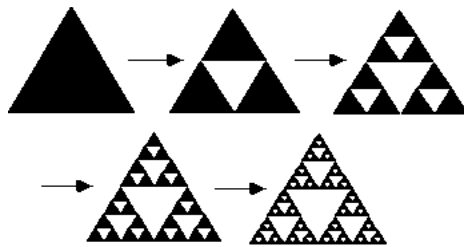


Figure 1: The Sierpinski Triangle

Many things in nature display fractality. Given their universality, laws of nature are often fractal. Fractionation is one of those universal principles that govern nature.

Previously, we discussed Fractionation in persuasion at a big picture level. Zooming in, you'll find Fractionation at work at multiple levels of interaction—

ENTICE/REPEL¹: The procedure of generating attraction ("A" stage in the IRAE Model) by cycling the woman through pleasure and pain.

The Black Rose Sequence²: Triggering of emotional enslavement through anchoring and sensual imagery.

One Sentence Fractionation: A simple verbatim that compresses both positive and negative emotional triggers into one sentence.

¹ Module 6 inside Shogun Method. See <https://shogunmethod.net/shogun-method/module-6/>

² Module 7 inside Shogun Method. See <https://shogunmethod.net/shogun-method/module-7/>

ENTICE/REPEL is Fractionation at a high, *strategic* level. (One level higher would be the IRAE Model). The Black Rose (or other Shogun Sequences) is Fractionation at the *story* level. The One Sentence Fractionation and Intrigue Pings are examples of Fractionation at the *sentence* level.

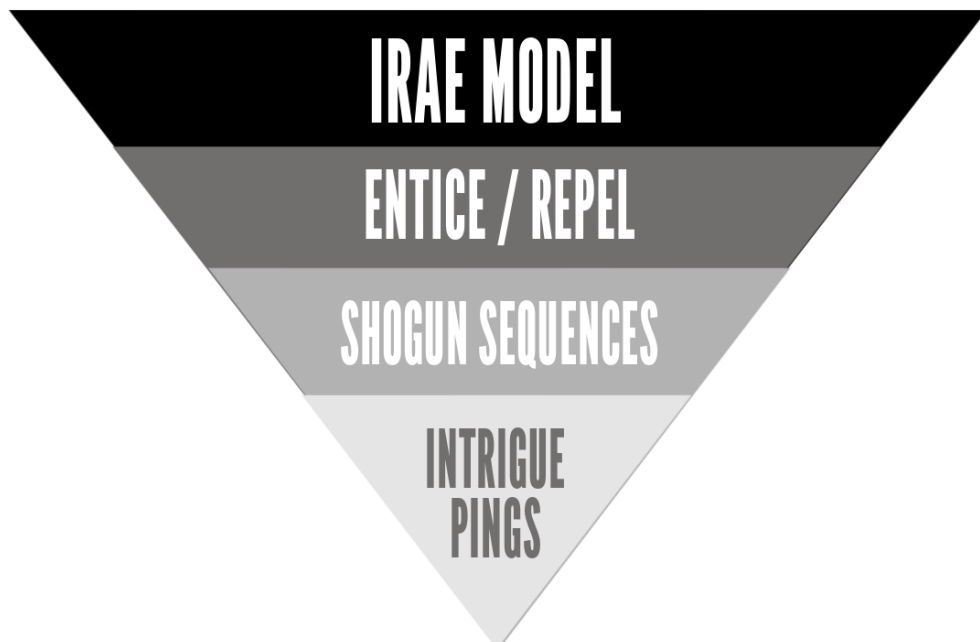


Figure 2: Fractal nature of Fractionation

**APPLYING FRACTALITY INSIDE
PERSUASION**

Since Fractionation is governed by the universal law of fractality, what works in Fractionation *seduction* also works in Fractionation *persuasion*.

For the seasoned Shogun, Fractionation may be reserved for high-powered situations only. An apt example would be a CEO whipping his workers into obedience and loyalty. A dominant leader may have the illusion of having faithful followers; slaves tend to rebel or escape. Fractionation is how the savvy leader plays the persuasion and influence game. He balances aggression with docility, swinging between the two extremes with no regularity or identifiable pattern.

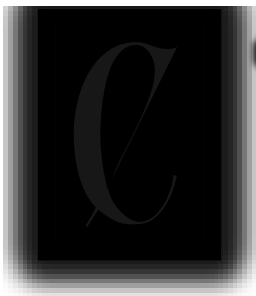
Unpredictability is key to power.

In Shogun Method, Fractionation is about emotional rollercoasters. Applying Fractionation inside persuasion requires generalizing the principle into a new framework-

Conflict and resolution.

CHAPTER II

FRACTIONATION II: CONFLICT & RESOLUTION



Conflict is persuasion.

This statement is profound. Most won't get it the first time. Heck, it took me years of research (and Shogun Method field experience) to arrive at this insight.

Conflict is persuasion.

A woman bonds with a man through emotional tension.

A man bonds with another man through conflict.

Conflict is persuasion.

Women thrive on emotional tension. Men thrive on conflict. Those are two different things.

Our male ancestors hunted wild animals for food. Sometimes, they fought each other over the spoils. Every day, they risked death to eat.

So, for tens of thousands of years, we men had been hunter-warriors. Nature was (and still is) a harsh bitch. We could die any moment—from getting mauled by a wild beast or speared by a rival caveman.

Our survival skyrocketed when we grouped to pool our strength, forming tribes. With power in numbers, we could prey on bigger, meatier animals like the woolly mammoth.

With this, we could, for the first time, have a surplus of food to keep. And soon, we attacked other tribes and pillage their food storage. After all, why hunt when you can rob and steal?

This was the genesis of war in the history of humankind.

So, unlike women, men had bonded over danger. Over war. Over conflict.

As a hunter-warrior in a tribe, you have to count on the others to watch your back. *Trust is not optional.* You have

to do your job and trust the others to do theirs. Or, everyone gets killed.

Banishment occurs when your tribe loses trust in you. Facing the wild on your own, your death is all but certain.

THE CURSE OF APPROVAL SEEKING

Here's the weird thing...

A man may thrive on conflict, but he may not actively seek it. In fact, we usually try to *avoid* conflict when we interact with people.

Why?

There are a couple of reasons, the biggest of which is this-

Approval seeking.

Remember, our survival depends on our acceptance in a tribe. Signals of approval from the tribe members are assurances of our safety. As a result...

- **We say, think and behave like what others expect us to.**

- **We steer clear of risk, avoiding anything that rocks the boat.**

- We suppress our individuality for the sake of acceptance into the group.

The inclusion into a tribe makes these behaviors necessary. And yet they are counterproductive when it comes to exerting power and influence.

Why?

Because if you are seeking to influence your mark, the coin is flipped the other way—

He should be the one who is seeking approval (from you).

This means:

- **He should say, think and behave like what you expect him to.**
- **He should avoid risking anything that offends you.**
- **He should suppress his own needs for your acceptance.**

As an indoctrinator (in the Anzaian sense), your goal is to induce this behavior in your mark. Like Shogun Method, it is anchored by a simple procedure:

First, create conflict. Then, resolve it.

In other words, *Fractionation*.

³ An Anzaian subscribes to the notion that the end game of influence is *indoctrination*, going beyond the confines of mainstream persuasion. See the final chapter.

THE PARADOX OF ANOMISITY

In 1187, Saladin seized Jerusalem.

Richard the Lionheart was eager to recapture Jerusalem for the crusaders. He routed Saladin's forces at Arsuf in 1191, but it had worn him out.

By the time Richard reached Jerusalem in 1192, he was completely drained. Having fallen ill, he did the unthinkable—to ask his nemesis for help. Saladin sent his personal physician Moses ben Maimon to treat him. And when Richard's horse got killed on the battlefield, Saladin gave him two mounts so that he didn't have to fight on foot.



Figure 3: Surrender of Jerusalem to Saladin in 1187

A noble (albeit ruthless) knight, Saladin had admired Richard's valor and battle skills. In fact, he had declared Richard to be the most honorable Christian king he had ever known. In return, Richard had praised Saladin as the greatest leader in the Muslim kingdom.

Saladin's relationship with Richard is one of mutual chivalrous admiration amidst military rivalry. The esteem and respect they held for each other was forged through conflict. *Animosity towards an opponent could easily morph into admiration and affection.*

We also see this in love and relationships. A woman professes to hate a man only to fall head over heels for him. Love and hate triggers the same emotions in a woman—tension, fluster, intrigue, aggravation, torment. Every Shogun knows this. The opposite of love is not hate, but indifference.

To build influence over your mark, create conflict. The easy way to do this, of course, to fight a shared enemy. Here is, however, a more powerful way to bond with anyone—wage conflict against him.

CONFLICT IS PERSUASION

Fractionation in seduction is about putting women on an emotional rollercoaster. Build tension. Release. Rebuild tension. Release. Repeat.

In Shogun Method, Fractionation is the overarching strategy. Everything revolves around the emotional rollercoaster. Intrigue Pings, Implanted Commands, Shogun Sequences, ENTICE/REPEL strategies—these are the hypnotic devices, the stories you tell to lead a woman through a journey of emotional ups and downs.

Fractionation in persuasion is similar. You force your mark's oscillation of emotions through a cycle of conflict and resolution. It is through tension and release—like seduction—that your mark develops deference to your authority.

My study in strategy and warfare—Clausewitz, Sun Tzu, Napoleon, Machiavelli, Jomini—had led to a surprising conclusion:

The best military asset is a turned enemy.

Because once you win an enemy over, he will be the most loyal ally that you can ever hope to have. The highest form of power is to harness an opposing force into an asset. To exert influence on a man, treat him with hostility.

First, make him your enemy. Then, secure his allegiance and he will tie himself to your cause for life.

Conflict is, without question, the best persuasion.

CHAPTER III

FRACTIONATION II: TENSION ADDICTION

The society divides into two classes-the indoctrinator and the indoctrinated.

The indoctrinated masses are like goldfish in a bowl. They may feel free, but their freedom is constrained within invisible boundaries. They assume they are independent thinkers and doers, dictating their thoughts and actions with reason and intellect. No.

The truth is that they live in a programmed environment, a goldfish bowl but for humans. And it is an environment laced with continual stress, unending anxiety, ceaseless conflict. It is programmed as thus because of one important principle—

Safety and comfort is possible only when there is conflict and tension.

The plebeians outnumber the rulers by a factor of at least 1,000,000 to 1. Mass control through physical coercion is a logistical impracticality. There is but one way to subdue the masses, and it's through psychology.

If the plebs poll their collective strength and revolt against the ruling class, it's over in a day. *The key to mass control is mass distraction.* Occupy their minds with a series of conflicts, release them from tension only to plunge them

into crisis again. This is how the rulers exert their grip on the plebeian masses despite being heavily outnumbered by directing their attention elsewhere.

ADDICTION TO TENSION

Fractionation is the first port of call for those new to Shogun Method.

To many rookie Shoguns, Fractionation is a revelatory experience. Because once you understand Fractionation, you see it everywhere. It's like a goldfish *seeing* the bowl it is in.

In sexual relationships, the endgame is emotional enslavement; Fractionation is how to get there. In the

broader world, the endgame is *indoctrination*. Fractionation is how to get there.

The universality (and fractality) of Fractionation results from a flaw in human nature—

An addiction to tension.

We have the natural tendency to avoid tension, and yet at the same time, conflict appeals to us. For example, some things may invoke fear; despite that, we find them fun. Indeed, those things are pleasurable *because* they cause stress and discomfort. This is a weird feature of our psychology and yet it's real.

The human mind hates peace and stillness. Try sitting down, closing your eyes and blanking your thoughts. Then,

see how long it takes before the brain rebels. If you can keep your mind empty for 60 seconds, you're exceptional.

The inability to be *still* is the difference between man and animal. Here's how. A beast doesn't need constant affirmation that it *exists*. A man does. He requires a regular confirmation that he is alive. And this confirmation comes through mental stimulation—from stress, tension and conflict.

THE STRANGE APPEAL OF PAIN

The [Shogun community](#) has the best repository of Fractionation knowledge in the world. It has, after all, the biggest concentration of people who use it in real life.

Here is, by far, my favorite case study posted by a Shogun inside the community—

“I’ve always been doing everything to please my woman. I’d hate to see her unhappy in any way, and yet, that’s what Fractionation calls for... so I did what I had to do. I’d fuck shit up just to give her some emotional turmoil. I acted like a dick. I ghosted her. I left town for a couple of days. My phone blew up.

“But, here’s what surprised me, Derek. She loved the pain more than pleasure. The more I made her suffer, the more she seemed to love me. That’s some weird shit, man. I don’t understand this at all.”

Derek Rake’s reply—

“It’s a psychological paradox. To the human mind, pain appeals more than pleasure. Sado-masochism has its roots in

this weird phenomenon. What is repulsive develops into something attractive. They are but the manifestation of the same emotion in the brain.

Once, a Shogun's girlfriend confessed to me. Derek, she said, he had stopped paying attention to me, and it killed me on the inside. So, the only way I could get his attention was to misbehave. She said, I wanted him to punish me. And when he did, it was joy... pure joy. I never thought I'd be happy to be hurt."

THE CONTEMPTIBLE UNIMPORTANCE OF MAN

What is true with women is true with the broader world.

Picture this—

The average man feels small. He feels he's a nobody. He does nothing important. His life is purposeless, humdrum, devoid of spirit and meaning.

He watches TV. He sees a rich guy, a sports star, a superhero. He imagines him to be them. He lives through their eyes for a short while. The fantasy ends and he snaps back to reality.

The average man feels unimportant because he is. And he is aware of this, painfully so. Contemptuous of his own insignificance, he seeks a way out.

**He sets his sights on a lofty goal. He takes up a cause.
He goes on a mission. And for the first time, his life is infused
with meaning.**

**Now, here's the thing. The actual goal, cause or
mission is *irrelevant*. What's important is that it intensifies his
emotions to affirm his existence. It must induce enough
pain for him to feel alive.**

A woman pursues a man. She's hurt, but she's happy.

A man pursues his mission. He's hurt, but he's happy.

**FRACTIONATION AS
INDOCTRINATION**

To navigate your way through the complication of the world, your task is two-fold.

The first step is *transcendence*.

You must see the world for what it is—a fabrication to secure your obedience and subservience. You must transcend beyond the boundaries that have been forced upon you. These constraints are fake, and you must knock them down.

Overcome your innate addiction to tension and conflict. Once you have done this, you're immune to the effects of Fractionation. You're unplugged from the proverbial matrix.

The second step is *appropriation*.

Fractionation is the weapon of the ruling elite to exert control over the masses. It is, as a tool, neutral; you can use it for good, or for bad. Like the elite, you can *appropriate* it to build your own following, to exert your will on others to do your bidding.

CHAPTER IV

PATTERN INTERRUPTS

Every day, most of us are in a hypnotic trance
and yet we don't realize it.

Every morning, we take the same routes to work.
Then, we sit on the desk, boot up the computer, login,
check email. We have meetings. We see the same people.
We eat at the same places, often the same kinds of food. And
we do the same things for fun.

If that's not hypnosis, what is?

You see, we have been conditioned to follow fixed behavioral patterns. We are pattern-driven down to the minutiae of details. Whether we humans truly have free will is the biggest philosophical question of our time.

And that's not all. Because of routine, we get trapped inside our own thoughts. We do something, but we have long forgotten why we do it. And that's why we keep doing it.

There's a word for this—*trance*.

People in trance are stubborn. People in trance think their way is the right way, the only way. People in trance dislike change. Thus, people in trance resist persuasion.

As a persuader, there is a barrier against change that you'll have to knock down. This barrier is psychological; it resides in the subconscious layer of the mark's mind. The Shogun's approach to persuasion is thus two-fold:

One: To snap the mark out of his default trance. And,

Two: Put the mark into the trance of the Shogun's design.

This, of course, bears similarity to the IRAE Model. The first step is akin to the Intrigue stage where you interrupt a woman's focus to capture her attention. The second step is Rapport stage onwards, culminating in the Black Rose at the end.

In this chapter, you'll learn a persuasion device called the Pattern Interrupt⁴. You will notice its resemblance to Intrigue Pings; after all, they both do the same thing—

To disrupt your mark's default trance.

WHAT IS A PATTERN INTERRUPT?

A Pattern Interrupt breaks your mark's regular thought and behavioral patterns. It short-circuits the mind, opening a brief window for persuasion and influence.

The mind is a cognitive miser. It prefers to stick to routine to save the energy otherwise spent on thinking.

⁴ See the full application of the use of Pattern Interrupts in love and attraction inside Module 3 of [Shogun Method Black Book Volume 3](#).

Knock the mind off-balance and it opens up to new ideas and suggestions. It is a tall order to persuade someone laced to rigid, ritualistic thinking.

When you pattern-interrupt your mark, you inject *discomfort* into his mind. This discomfort comes from uncertainty. Routine anchors a person's thought process from A to Z. And when the thought pattern breaks, his subconscious mind is at a loss for the next step.

The mind remains in the state of discomfort until the question of "what is the next step" resolves. When the answer doesn't come from within, it looks to outside sources. *This lets the persuader to insert new instructions into the mark's subconscious.*

Imagine you're walking to work. You have your earphones on. You're lost in your thoughts, your mind on cruise control.

A thundering explosion jolts you out of your daydream. Thick, black smoke billows into the sky. Intense heat sears into your face.

You panic. *What the fuck is going on?* Your subconscious—the part of the brain that keeps you on autopilot—shuts down. You break out of your default trance.

Your subconscious mind doesn't know how to process the confusion. What should I do next? Remember—the subconscious is bad at making decisions. That's the job of the conscious mind.

So, what does the subconscious mind do, then?

This—it waits for instructions. It has to come from somewhere, anywhere. And when it comes, your subconscious mind accepts it without resistance.

Back to the example. In delirium, you will accept any help that comes your way. You'll go to wherever the guiding hands lead you.

THE STRANGENESS OF PATTERN INTERRUPTS

Try this when you see a friend or co-worker talking on the phone.

Pick up anything—say, a pen, an alarm clock, a mug, whatever. Then, approach him abruptly and hand it to him.

What happens?

High chances are that he will accept it without question. He may be confused, but he'll never ask you why. It is likely he'll continue talking on the phone while holding the thing in his hand.

Strange, right?

Looking at the incident from the hypnotist cum persuader lens, we understand why—

1. The mark is in the default trance, induced by the phone conversation.

2. You hand him the random thing, interrupting his trance.

3. In confusion, his subconscious mind accepts your suggestion (“hold this thing”) without resistance.

4. His default trance resumes.

Like many hypnosis techniques, Pattern Interrupts are strange, but they work. And here's the thing... sometimes the weirder the Pattern Interrupt, the more effective it is.

SPICY PORK CRACKLINGS

You're dealing with Greg, a subordinate at work. Despite being his boss, he doesn't readily obey your instructions.

Greg is one stubborn SOB with a habit of doing things in an inefficient, roundabout way. You want to show him a better way to do his work.

You: "Are you doing your reports, Greg?"

Greg: "Yes."

You: "There's an easier way of doing them."

Greg: "I always do them like this."

You: “Spicy pork cracklings. I just had one, and my mouth is on fire.”

Greg: “Huh?”

[Wait a few moments while you fiddle around with something].

You: “If you sort those files by date instead of order number, you’ll get through them quicker. Just thought you’d like a shortcut, yes?”

Let’s take a closer look at why that works.

When you asked Greg about his work, his defences went up. He expected you to give him advice that he didn’t ask for. And he readied himself to dispute you.

But that didn't happen. Instead, you delivered a Pattern Interrupt—spicy pork scratchings. You broke his habitual pattern of thought, lowering his defenses temporarily.

Then, you used the window of opportunity to teach him a better way to do his work. This is a privileged moment where his resistance to new ideas is at its lowest.

In Shogun Method, a woman in such a state is said to be in Hot mode. When your mark is cognitively Hot, his vulnerability to persuasion is high.

SELLING WITH PATTERN INTERRUPTS

Sales people know how quick people are to blow them off. This is usually the result of poor technique. Most salesmen have a standard pitch-reasons the prospect should buy their product.

These stock sales pitches rain down on us a hundred times a day. Because of this, we find them repulsive. We know if someone is trying to sell us something and we shut them down by instinct.

In the context of seduction, that is equivalent to using stock pickup lines on a woman. A decent looking female gets hit on frequently and she would have heard every pickup line there is. She knows if a guy is trying to get into her knickers and she shuts him down instinctively.

In Shogun Method, overriding a woman's *defensive default* is the first step. Shoguns do this with Intrigue Pings.

In persuasion, overriding the mark's *defensive default* should be the first step. You can do this with Pattern Interrupts.

Star salespeople are masters at Pattern Interrupts. They know there's one thing that's more important than the sales pitch, and it's this—

Knowing how to interrupt the prospects' default behavioral patterns.

Telemarketers are annoying. Why? Because they disrupt our lives without giving us anything in return. Most never figure out how to break the customer's default pattern-of picking up the phone, hearing a salesman and hanging up. Those who do win the game.

Here are some examples.

“Hey there, it’s John Smith, does the name ring a bell?”

[Get a quick yes-or-no solicitation to get the ball rolling]

***“OK, this is a sales call. If you want to hang up, I totally get it.
But if you stick with me, you’ll have fun. Let me show you the fun!”***

[Upfront admission and what’s-in-it-for-you]

“This is crazy, but I’m looking for some help...”

[Nobody refuses to help when asked]

“My name’s John and I want to talk to you. Can you do that for me?”

[Request a small favor]

“Question. What happens if someone dies at your workplace?”

[Shock the prospect. Only works if it fits into the sales pitch]

SUMMARY

Your mark is living in his own stubborn reality. With Pattern Interrupts, you’ll snap him out of his trance and put him into the one you control.

Attention capture is the first step in persuasion. To persuade a mark, break his routine. And you do this in two steps—

One. Know your mark's defensive default behavior.

Two. Design a Pattern Interrupt that overrides this default behavior.

Finally, remember the purpose of a Pattern Interrupt. It opens up the privileged window of persuasion, *but it does not persuade the mark.* In Shogun Method lexicon, it switches the mark from “Cold” to “Hot”. Intrigue opens up the opportunity for a hypnotic trance, all the way to Enslavement.

There are, however, differences between Pattern Interrupts and Intrigue Pings:

First, Intrigue Pings follow a specific structure. Pattern Interrupts don't.

Second, the best Intrigue Pings are contextual. (Non-contextual Intrigue Pings are not Intrigue Pings, but Convo Seeds⁵). Pattern Interrupts don't have to be. In fact, they may sound jarring to the mark, and that's the point.

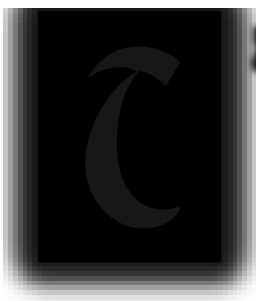
Third, good Intrigue Pings escalate the mark from Intrigue to Rapport automatically. For example, intrigue a woman enough and she'll pursue you.

⁵ Convo Seeds are available as a bonus program that comes free with [TextingOnSteroids 2.0](#).

Even the best Pattern Interrupts can't persuade the mark for you. It primes the mark to take the first step up the persuasion ladder; this commonly comes in the form of the (aptly named) Yes Ladder.

CHAPTER V

YES LADDERS



Think of a politician you hate.

Do you see him in your mind now? Yes?

Good. Now, think about this. Why do you dislike him?

Donald Trump was the most polarizing American president in history. His detractors distrusted him, saying he didn't have consistent views on things. For his perceived instability, people looked at him with a suspicious eye.

This is not a partisan phenomenon. Ask a Republican and he'll complain about the same about the Democrats. *Biden says one thing and does the opposite!*

Politicians are despised because of their spins, lies, deceit... and the lack of a backbone. They commit the ultimate betrayal when they switch their allegiance to another party. When Winston Churchill switched parties (he did it twice!), he suffered the derision of a "party rat".

Why is *inconsistency* such a problem?

THE LINEARITY OF THE MIND

Like a computer, the human brain processes information in an orderly, linear fashion. The key word here is *linear*. Humans think in a straight line⁶.

The brain faces a barrage of stimuli from the environment to the tune of thousands per second. It is impossible to *examine* each stimulus and decide the appropriate response. Consistency is a shortcut that frees the brain from cognitive paralysis.

For this reason, the brain depends on things being predictable. We like things that are formulaic. In a world that is wild and uncertain, consistency provides safety and assurance. Anything that seems inconsistent immediately triggers discomfort and distrust.

⁶ This linearity in thinking also extends to our behavior. The IRAE Model maps how a woman falls in love—in a straight-line sequence.

So, by the same token, we favor people who are consistent in the things they do and the things they say. And similarly, we want to *appear* consistent with others. After all, what's worse than people branding you erratic and undependable?

THE LADDER OF AGREEMENT

Are you sick and tired of waking up with back pain?

Do you wish there's an easier way to file your taxes?

Are you upset because your boss treats you like a slave?

Have you ever noticed how ads often start with questions like that?

This is a deliberate strategy—a strategy known as the Yes Ladder. It is a way of getting the viewer into a ladder—the ladder of *agreement*. Get a man to say yes once and he'll be more inclined to say yes later.

The Yes Ladder is a simple technique, but is ridden by nuance. The trick to make it natural to respond with the affirmative. *The ladder must be effortless to climb.*

In a Yes Ladder, the two questions that are most important are the first and the last. We call the former the Simple Ask, and the latter, the Big Ask.

In Shogun Method Black Book's module of the Yes Ladder⁷, I describe the Simple Ask in the case study

⁷ Module 2 inside [Shogun Method Black Book Volume 2](#)

involving hypnotism. In the example, the hypnotist starts the Yes Ladder by asking the subject—

“Can you hear my voice clearly?”

Answering yes is as trivial as it gets.

Then, the hypnotist ladders up to the second question.

“I’m going to place my hand on yours for a second.” [Places hand on the subject.] ***“Can you feel my hand?”***

Again, the subject has no other choice but to answer yes.

The hypnotist asks the third question—

“Do you feel the trance getting a little more intense?”

This is a bigger ask, but the subject is more inclined to answer yes, having primed by the previous two smaller asks.

The *gradual* asking of commitment underpins hypnotism and the inducement of trance. It is key to good Yes Ladder design; the mark must be led into agreement in an easy, frictionless manner.

CONSTRUCTING THE YES LADDER.

We have covered the Simple Ask in the Yes Ladder. Let's now look at the Big Ask.

The Big Ask is the result you want. It corresponds to the Big Yes that you desire in the end. Want a co-worker to support your proposal? Trying to close a sale? Convincing the cop not to issue you a ticket?

Whatever the Big Yes is, keep the question in your mind. This is where all your questions should ladder up to in the end.

Now that you have the start and end points (Simple and Big Asks respectively), build out the rungs on the ladder. Connect both with a series of questions with a gradual increase of commitment.

Let's look at an example. You are a door-to-door salesman selling insurance. Your Big Yes is to get the prospect to agree to a meeting. Not a sale. The Big Ask is a

meeting to find out if it's sensible for the prospect to buy insurance.

You: "Hello! This is King Avenue, yes?" *[Simple Ask.]*

Prospect: "Yes, it is."

You: "Thank you. And this is house number 74?"

Prospect: "Correct."

You: "Great, and you live here?"

Prospect: "Yes."

[Keep this up with a few more situational questions which the prospect will agree with.]

You: “Excellent. Well, I sell home insurance. I’m guessing this house is worth somewhere around 600k. Does that sound right?”

[Slight risk of getting this wrong. Do your homework.]

Prospect: “Yeah, I suppose so.”

You: “You’d want to ensure such an investment keeps its value, yes?”

Client: “Of course.”

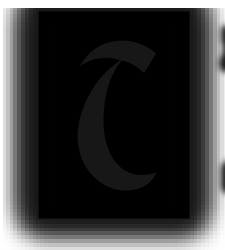
You: "Insurance for a place like this wouldn't be much. Only a few dollars a month, but the returns are great. Would you like a short meeting to discuss things? We can do it now or tomorrow."

See how it starts innocently with a series of Simple Asks, and then gradually ramps up to the Big Ask?

Remember—you may want to augment your Big Ask with other persuasion devices. In this example, I've used the Double Bind in the end to close the deal. We will cover this technique in Chapter VII.

CHAPTER VI

PAGE/LEAD



here's this weird thing about pet dogs. They almost always look like their owners.

That's not a mere modern day myth. It's a scientific fact. In 2004, two researchers asked some volunteers to match the pictures of dogs to their owners based on appearance. Their conclusion—

(The results suggest that) when people pick a pet, they seek one that, at some level, resembles them⁸.

**This may be surprising, but we know it to be true—
anecdotally, at least. We can observe this phenomenon at
the park. A trim jogger is usually seen with a Labrador
retriever, right? Who owns a cuddly chihuahua? An equally
cuddly, petite Asian girl. A burly thug's pet of choice? A
pugnacious bulldog, of course.**

THE SIMILARITY EFFECT

**Humans choose not only dogs based on physical
resemblances. We are instinctively attracted to**

⁸ Michael M. Roy, J.S. Christenfeld Nicholas. [Do Dogs Resemble Their Owners?](#)

people who look like us. Indeed, the *Similarity Effect* is a prime factor in how humans choose company.

Again, this makes intuitive sense. Who are the people we hang out with? They are those who dress the same way, like the same things, enjoy the same music, laugh at the same jokes. We are comfortable with our friends because they're so similar—in both appearance and behavior.

In the IRAE Model, Rapport is the second stage in the sequence of four. Similarity is a rapport builder; when we meet someone who is like us, we can't help but to be friendly. And that's why mirroring is such an effective way to establish rapport.

Similarity breeds likeability. It signals to the mark's subconscious mind that he's in friendly company. As he lets his guard down, it gets easier to make him comply with your

requests. This is why the Rapport stage precedes Attraction in Shogun Method, and Compliance in the [Anzai Protocol](#).

PACE/LEAD

Pace/Lead is a persuasion technique based on the Similarity Effect.

In the Shogun Method knowledge universe, it's found in the second volume of the Shogun Method Black Book. Here, we are generalizing it for the use in everyday persuasion situations.

The Pace/Lead process has two stages—

- **The Pace Stage:** You match your mark's behavior.

This is where you create rapport with your mark by finding the Common Ground between you and him.

- **The Lead Stage:** You now lead the mark towards your desired result.

Next, let's look at each of these stages in detail.

THE PACE STAGE

You pace your mark in two steps. First, by *mirroring* him physically.

Is he sitting down? Where is he placing her hands? Does he speak softly, or is he a loudmouth? Does he have an

accent? Does he have a behavioral quirk? Does he nod or rub his nose or crack his knuckles? How about verbal quirks?

There is, of course, danger that he figures out what you're doing. He may feel insulted—especially if you're mimicking something undesirable, maybe a nervous tick. Sidestep this pitfall by following these two rules:

- **Rule #1: Stick to mirroring safe, neutral cues. Avoid the obvious and the negative.**
- **Rule #2: Delay each mirroring act by five seconds. For example, if he crosses his legs, only cross your legs five seconds later.**

The second step in the Pace Stage is *verbal mirroring*. This comes in three parts—

- **Part 1:** Repeat the mark's statement in verbatim, or rephrase them in a familiar manner.
- **Part 2:** Reaffirm the statement by agreeing with it.
- **Part 3:** State why you agree with it.

Here's an example.

Mark: *"People are poor because they're lazy."*

Repeat the statement verbatim, or reword it—

"People just don't like to put in the work, right? That's why they don't get far in life, I guess."

Reaffirm it—

“I think you’re right.”

Then, state why—

“I’ve never seen a guy who works his butt off and stays poor.”

**Pacing is finding the Common Ground from which
you can lead your mark to the desired conclusion.
Subconsciously, this is the message you want to send across—**

***“I am a friendly, familiar person. Trust me. We have
common ground.”***

THE LEAD STAGE

Once you have paced the mark, it's time to take the lead. Starting from the Common Ground, gently guide him to where you want him to be.

Continuing from the previous example—

“Success is when hard work meets opportunity. Now, here’s the thing, though. Without opportunity, hard work can only bring you that far. So, it’s probably fair to say that everyone deserves an equal shot, yes?”

Now, contrast this with a more confrontational approach—

“You’re wrong. People are poor because they don’t get the same opportunities as the rich.”

Hardly persuasive.

The acute Shogun will notice another persuasion technique in use—the Yes Ladder⁹. Do you see it?

“People just don’t like to put in the work, right? [YES.] That’s why they don’t get far in life, I guess. [I AGREE.]”

“I think you’re right. [OF COURSE I AM.] I’ve never seen a guy who works his butt off and stays poor.”

“Success is when hard work meets opportunity. [AGREE.] Now here’s the thing, though. Without opportunity, hard work can

⁹ See Chapter V.

only bring you that far. So, it's probably fair to say that everyone deserves an equal shot, yes? [YES.]”

SITUATIONAL EXAMPLES

PITCHING TO CLIENTS

First, match the pace of the client by monitoring his language. What out-of-ordinary words does he use? Every business has its own jargon. An excellent source of intelligence are the emails he sends.

Then, use the same words in the pitch. Tailor your solution as if it's designed by the client himself. Make it look like your proposal is his own idea.

JOB INTERVIEWS

Pacing by mimicking the posture of your interviewer is easy. Extra points for matching his tonality and breathing pattern.

To lead, get the interviewer to visualize you already working at his company.

“If I was part of your team, I’d ensure...”

To be more convincing, use the company’s jargon so it’s as if you’re already one of them. This technique is known as *Thinking Past The Sale* in mainstream persuasion.

HOSTILE SITUATIONS

If the other person is hostile to you, mirroring him could provoke him further. If he's shouting at you, shouting back will not help, right?

Here, focus on verbal mirroring. To diffuse his anger, say:

"I understand why you're angry. And you should be angry. I would be, too."

That's where you should start from—the Common Ground.

Then, follow up with:

"X is important to you, I understand. Are there other things to consider? For example..."

NOISY NEIGHBORS

As always, start with the Common Ground.

“Metallica? Orion rocks. Cliff Burton’s the best.”

Then, continue with the small talk, finally leading to:

“Any chance of dialling it down a little, though? Old man Hetfield would approve.”

SALES SITUATIONS

First, pace by finding the Common Ground. This is usually the similarities between you (the seller) and the client.

Then lead by getting the client to visualize the future with you as their vendor. This is where you make your sales pitch.

Here's an example. Let's say you're cold-calling companies to sell them pens and pencils.

You: "Hi, is that the head of purchasing?"

Client: "It is."

Find the Common Ground.

You: "Great, I hope you don't mind me calling you on a gloomy Monday morning. I thought you'd like to save

money on your stationery. I understand that every cent counts, especially for someone in your position.”

Client: “We’re good, thanks.”

You: “I understand that you’re probably happy with your current supplier. But what if you could get everything but 20% cheaper? Both [two rival companies] have switched to us in the last month.”

Wait for the Pacing to take effect.

Client: “Okay, what have you got?”

Lead. Make your pitch by painting the bright future (with you).

You: “This will get you in [the CEO]’s good books for boosting the bottom line for sure. And of course, there’ll never be stationery shortage again. The purchasing department will be a star!”

Remember—all sales are personal, even when you’re dealing with companies. Appeal to the decision maker’s self-interest. This is where your Pace/Lead strategy should focus on.

SUMMARY

The Pace/Lead is, in essence, persuasion in its purest form. After all, to persuade someone is to first start from where he is (Pace), and prodding him to where you want (Lead).

In persuasion, like the IRAE Model, the process is sequential. Pace comes before Lead. Don't lead without first pacing the mark. You must always find the Common Ground; in many instances, this is where 90% of your persuasion will lie.

Sometimes, the resistance of the mark will too severe to match his Pace. In which case, verbal mimicking should be your tool of choice. If you still get nowhere, disengage and bid your time for a better opportunity.

Pacing in persuasion is Rapport stage in Shogun Method. Problems of Contextual Rapport are also present in general persuasion situations. That is why a co-worker may be compliant at work, but outside the workplace, he may not be submitting to your charm that readily.

CHAPTER VII

DOUBLE BINDS

Question. Do you want to learn the Double Bind now or save it until later?

You can continue reading and learn this new persuasion technique in the next few minutes. Or, you can do your chores, have lunch and come back later to where you've left. No pressure.

Made your choice?

Good. Well, you're still here, so let's continue.

And, by the way, I've just used the Double Bind on you. Did you notice?

IMAGINARY BOUNDARIES

The Double Bind is a persuasion technique that guides your mark towards the choice you want him to make. It creates an *imaginary set of boundaries* in his mind to make things favorable to you.

I've asked you if you had wanted to learn the Double Bind now (option A), or later (option B). Both options would end with the same result: *learning the Double Bind*

***technique.* There is, of course, the option of not learning it at all (option C).**

Here's the weird thing about the mind—when presented with A and B, it's oblivious to C. The trick is to occupy the mind with A and B, blinding it from seeing C.

In the third volume of the Shogun Method Black Book¹⁰, you've seen the Double Bind in action—

“What do you like in me—my sense of humor or my sense of style?”
(Intrigue Ping variation)

“Should we just kiss, or do you want to go all the way?”
(Escalation from Rapport to Attract in the IRAE Model)

¹⁰ Module Five— <https://shogunmethod.net/shogun-method-black-book-vol-3/>

“Are you going to break up with your boyfriend this week or next?” (Boyfriend Destroyer variation)

“Do you miss me enough to get back with me yet, or are you going to make yourself wait another week?” (ReSeduction variation)

All these obscure the woman from option C (*I don't like you, I'm not getting physical with you, I'm not dumping my boyfriend, I'm not coming back to you*). Options A and B both lead her to where you want her to be.

Sneaky? Sure. Manipulative. Hell, yeah. And yet you see this everywhere, every day, often done by people unconsciously—

Parents will ask their children: “Do you want to go to bed now or in half an hour?”

Your boss may ask you: “Are you working through the weekend, or only on Saturday?”

Your girlfriend might say: “That new In-N-Out has opened up. Are we going today or tomorrow?”

In the business world, the Double Bind means serious money.

Star Wars or The Avengers? Doesn't matter. Disney gets your dollar either way.

Adidas or Reebok? Doesn't matter. The same company owns both brands.

Porsche or a Lambo? Doesn't matter. They both belong to Volkswagen.

Like Fractionation, once you understand the Double Bind, you'll see it everywhere. The illusion of choice is pernicious, and yet it is covertly pervasive in our lives.

THE THIRD OPTION

When they give you two choices—think about the third. And the fourth. And then, possibly the fifth.

This is, of course, doesn't come naturally to most people. After all, it takes mental effort to think beyond what's immediately obvious, what's in front of us. You don't look at a buffet spread and think about what's missing, right?

The brain abhors free choice, it's true. We might say we want free choices, but the truth might surprise you—because we *don't*.

Humans like to be told what to feel, when to feel it. We like to be guided towards the correct choice. This guidance is usually explicit when you are being sold something. Other times, these signals are implicit, usually as social proof¹¹.

These instances—explicit and implicit—tell you what to do, how to act, how to feel. And people obey these guidance signals like clockwork. Compliance is easy to extract from people with techniques like the Double Bind.

¹¹ Canned laughter in TV shows. Tip jars pre-stacked with dollar bills. Long lines outside clubs. The camera zooming in on a fan's shock after an improbable home run.

Seasoned persuaders pair the explicitness of the Double Bind with an implicit tactic like social proof. Let's see how to do this next.

DOUBLE BIND IN ACTION

Rookie salesmen rely on hard sell techniques. The more experienced ones are more... *subtle*. Understated. Covert, even.

As Shoguns, we know that obliquity is the way. Indirectness works on women. Heck, it works even better on men.

Consider this example. Let's say you've just bought a new phone. The salesgirl then says to you:

“You must get the extended warranty. It’s absolutely essential. Buy it or you’ll regret it.”

A hard sell like that turns me off pretty quickly. It probably won’t work on you, too.

How about this line, though?

“Do you want extended warranty? You don’t really need it, but it might be useful.”

A little better. At least, when she stops reeking of desperateness, her offer seems somewhat palatable. Here’s the problem, though. You can still say no, right? Option C is clearly on the table.

How about this instead?

“Which warranty do you prefer, basic or extended? Most people go basic.”

Under the hood, you’ll see the Double Bind in action—

- **Imaginary Boundaries.** Which option, basic or extended? A or B?

- **Absence of Option C.** Offer rejection is not explicitly mentioned.

- **Social Proof.** Most people will choose option A.

In the core Shogun Method program, there’s a Rapport stage tactic called Shared Secrets. The trick here is

to share an insider's secret as means to building rapport with the mark. The salesgirl could use this tactic for an upsell—

“Most people go basic. Some take up extended, so, it depends... last month, a customer dropped his phone and cracked the screen. They replaced it immediately for him. We're not supposed to tell this to the customer... but they're too lazy to send for repairs. So they give out new phones to replace the faulty ones. Crazy, right?”

Did you notice these techniques at play?

- **Us vs Them.** The salesgirl is taking the side of the customer, referring to the shop as *they*.
- **Impartiality.** *It depends* implies disinterest; she is not there to push the offer on you.

- **Insider Knowledge.** *We're not supposed to tell this to the customer* prefaces the Shared Secret.

Here are a few more Double Bind examples:

"What is a good time to meet next? Monday 2pm or Tuesday 4pm?"

"Tea or coffee?"

"Which one of these two options works best for you?"

"How would you like to pay, cash or credit card?"

"Is one enough, or do you want two?"

With social proof:

“How much do you want to deposit? 10% is the minimum. Most pay the minimum.”

With social proof and scarcity:

“Would you prefer the red or the yellow? Most choose the red, so we’re running out of that one.”

SUMMARY

Here’s the Double Bind technique in summary—

Give your mark two options. Both should lead him to the same decision that you want him to make.

There are two downsides to the technique.

One, it's less effective on someone who is familiar with the technique. (You'll now look for Option C by instinct, won't you?)

And two, it's hard to present only two options in complicated situations.

The Double Bind is thus best used in situations where your mark can decide quickly. And for added effect, pile it up with social proof, scarcity and Shared Secrets.

CHAPTER VIII

MULTIPLE OUTS

Compared to Double Binds, Multiple Outs are less well known, though not less effective.

The usage of Multiple Outs in mainstream persuasion is rather limited. It is, however, popular in fringe communities in hypnotism, magic, mentalism. You'll see why in a while.

In the Shogun Method world, Multiple Outs had found its way into our community around 2018. A show

hypnotist, Cronos had used the technique to force the compliance of his subjects on stage.

He brought the idea to Derek Rake, and the group spent some time fitting the technique inside the IRAE Model. Finally, we found a variant that complements the use of Rapport-stage Implanted Commands. You can find this in the fourth module of the Shogun Method Black Book.

In this chapter, we'll look at Multiple Outs and how to use the technique in persuasion and influence.

WHAT ARE MULTIPLE OUTS?

Originally known as *fishing*, Multiple Outs exploits a peculiarity in the English language. And

since we can find this trait only in English, this technique is relevant only for this language.

A Multiple Out question is one in which the asker is correct no matter what the mark answers, yes or no.

Here's an example. Imagine asking your girlfriend or wife—

“You don’t want to see your mom for Christmas, do you?”

Some who read this line will see it as a statement (“You don’t want to see your mom”). The others will see it as a question (“Do you want to see your mom?”)

Let's consider each scenario. If your partner sees it as a statement, she'll imagine you telling her not to see her mom on Christmas. The word don't rings out in her mind:

"You don't want to see your mom for Christmas."

Now, if she sees it as a question, she'll hear it as a question—

"Do you want to see your mom for Christmas?"

Important—you're not putting any emphasis anywhere in your delivery. This way, you're letting her interpret it whichever way her brain tells her to.

If she thinks you're asking a question, she might say "no, I don't want to."

Or, if she thinks it's a statement, she might say "you're right, I don't."

HOW MULTIPLE OUTS WORK

What's the point of using Multiple Outs?

One word: *ambiguity*. You can retroactively apply your intentions depending on your mark's response.

Let's say you dread going to your in-law's on Christmas. You'd rather stay home with your wife. So, using the previous example, you ask her—

“You don’t want to see your mom for Christmas, do you?”

There are three outcomes.

One: She doesn’t want to go, and you get bonus points for reading her mind.

Two: She wants to go, but she sees your Multiple Out as a statement, and she obeys it.

Three: She wants to go, and she sees your Multiple Out as a question. And she says, “Yes.”

In the first two instances, you score a win. In the third, you don’t win immediately, but it sets the stage for further persuasion. Knowing where she stands, you can then build

**Common Ground and lead her to the conclusion you want.
This is the Pace/Lead technique, covered in Chapter VI.**

**So, you'll win two times out of three, and in the third,
exceptional case, it'll set you up for Pace/Lead.**

WORKPLACE PERSUASION EXAMPLES

**Shoguns know how to be covert by asking
questions instead of making overt statements. Just as
with women, making outright demands at work are
counter-persuasive.**

**Structured as an innocuous question, Multiple Outs
steer your mark to what you favor.**

Here's an example.

It's 8pm on Thursday. Your team has been working on an important project. You're eager to get it done before the weekend. Your boss wants to meet on Friday to sort out some paperwork.

And so you say to your boss—

“You don't want to meet over paperwork tomorrow morning, do you?”

Your boss may interpret this in two ways:

One, you're asking him, “Are we meeting tomorrow morning?”

Two, you're saying, "Let's not have that meeting tomorrow."

Your intention, of course, is the second one. It's more persuasive because it's structured as a question.

If he says "yes, I want to meet", then you can use the Pace/Lead trick on him. First, agree (i.e. Pace) and then highlight the importance of the project versus paperwork (i.e. Lead).

Here's another scenario:

A co-worker is writing a report which you need urgently. Say—

"You haven't finished that report, have you?"

Ideal response: “No, I’ll get it done today.”

If he gets confrontational, say, “Just checking. There are some changes and I thought I’d save you from unnecessary rework.”

SALES PERSUASION EXAMPLES

Multiple Outs are a useful persuasion tool for salespeople. It shows they understand what the customer needs-better than the customer himself.

Example-

“You haven’t been thinking of getting home insurance, have you?”

If she has, she’ll respond with something like “yes, how did you know?” and it’s smooth sailing from there.

If she says no, then it’s an opening for your sales pitch. “Yes, I thought not. Well, perhaps it’s time to think about it.”

In both scenarios, you’ve guessed correctly, giving you a foot in the door to hawk your wares.

Here are a few more sales-based examples:

“Your car hasn’t been giving you trouble, has it?”

“You haven’t been thinking of moving house, have you?”

“It’s not time to buy a new phone, is it?”

SUMMARY

The key to Multiple Outs is the “you don’t...” part of the line. Every Multiple Outs statement needs something akin to this, such as “you haven’t...” or “you wouldn’t...”

Grammarians call these *Conjungated Question Tags*. They are not present in most other major languages. For this reason, Multiple Outs most possibly work only in English.

And like Double Binds, they can give you a way to guide your mark to the choice you want him to make.

It's a way to score a quick win, especially when the mark is on the fence about a decision. In more complicated situations, use it to bridge to a more robust technique, i.e. Pace/Lead.

Remember to keep your delivery crisp and neutral. Keep the tone flat and avoid emphasizing any word. You want your mark come to his own conclusions, albeit one that you prefer.

CHAPTER IX

INNER/OUTER WORLDS

Most of the time, when you are awake, you deal with the outside world. Your focus goes to whatever captures your attention.

Here's an example. As you're reading this chapter, your attention goes to what's on this page. You interpret and blend the words with your experiences, forming a narrative in your mind. And you'll continue reading until something distracts you, or if you decide to stop to do another task.

Your consciousness mostly, therefore, is about things external to you. Whether it's for work or play, your attention continually shifts from an object or person to another that demands it.

There are also times when you break from the outside world and go deep into your inner thoughts. You may call this your inner sanctum. This is where you get to daydream, to fantasize, to think about the future.

And when this happens, your consciousness flips and your awareness turns inwards.

As you'll probably notice, your mind is never 100% internally or externally aware. Indeed, as you go about your day, your consciousness goes back-and-forth between internal and external mental states.

CONSCIOUSNESS CONTROL

What does this have to do with social influence and persuasion?

Good question. And here's the answer—

Influence is about flipping your mark's consciousness from the external to the internal.

In this chapter, we are going to look at the nuts and bolts of the mechanics of social influence. As you will see, how well you can influence your mark depends on how you capture and direct his awareness.

Or, as Derek Rake would say:

“Influence is consciousness control.”

Warning—

The section that follows is slightly more complicated than the regular Shogun Method X material. And there's a fair bit of jargon, too.

Bear with me, however, because this is important. I will take you from start to the end, step-by-step. You've now covered nearly 90% of Shogun Method X material, and the rest should be a walk in the park for you. Pat yourself in the back because you deserve it.

Let's begin with the *two worlds* that our mind lives in.

THE INNER & OUTER WORLDS

The human mind lives in two worlds—the Inner World, and the Outer World.

What makes the two worlds different is where your *sensorial focus* is.

In the Outer World, your sensorial focus on things outside your mind.

Sensory acuity is crucial in the Outer World. To deal with situations effectively, you keep your senses sharp to outside things. You're alert and ready to act. You deal with things swiftly as they come your way.

In the Inner World, sensory acuity takes a different twist. Your senses turn inwards – you feel, see and hear *inwardly*.

When you close your eyes and revisit a memory, or when you visualize the future, you are in your Inner World.

See the difference?

Now here's the thing about our consciousness. *At any moment, we can only either be in the Inner World or the Outer World.*

This means that we cannot be in both the Inner and the Outer World at the same time.

The reason for this lies in how the brain works.

HOW THE HUMAN BRAIN WORKS

It's counter intuitive and yet it's true-the brain only works one way:

In sequence.

Our minds process one thing after another in strict order. It can't think two thoughts at the same time. (Just as you can't speak two words at the same time.)

Of course, we may sometimes feel that we exist in the Inner and the Outer Worlds both at once.

Have you ever lapsed into a daydream during at work?
Yes?

But let me tell you this: it's an illusion. You merely go back and forth between the two Worlds quickly.

When you are daydreaming, you're in your Inner World. And when your co-worker rudely interrupts you, you snap out and go back to the Outer World. You've never been in both Worlds at the same time.

Makes sense?

Good. To understand this further, let me ask you this:

Which is more important—the Inner, or the Outer World?

Let's find out.

THE BIGGER MENTAL TOOLBOX

Here's the answer to that question-*it depends.*

Why? Because you need different mental states for different tasks.

Take crossing a busy street, for example. You need to pay attention to the traffic coming your way. Letting your thoughts drift, in this case, could be disastrous.

Often, we don't do well because we are in the wrong mental state for what we do. It's hard to solve a Sudoku puzzle when you're in the mental state of, say, playing basketball.

Think of mental states as toolboxes with the tools and resources to perform tasks and solve problems. Being in the right mental state is like having the right toolbox for the right task.

Sometimes, we get stuck with something difficult. We get completely stumped. We run out of resources in our conscious mind to deal with the problem.

The solution? Use the bigger toolbox, of course: *the subconscious mind*.

All the hype you've heard about the subconscious is true. It's more powerful than you might think, considering what it does—

- **It makes up 90% of your brain power.**

- **It stores all your thoughts and emotions.**
- **It documents your experiences and future hopes.**
- **It records your habits, personality and patterns of behavior.**

And it does all that, while running your body like clockwork. Remarkable, isn't it?

Now, here's the tricky bit about the subconscious mind—it's hard to access. And that's why it remains an untapped resource for most people.

Is there a way to consciously make your subconscious work for you (as paradoxical as that may sound)?

The answer is yes.

THE PATH TO THE SUBCONSCIOUS MIND

The Inner World gives us the path to the subconscious mind, an opportunity to explore our hidden internal resources.

We all have rich personal experiences, giving us the resources that we can draw upon at will.

These tools, however, are buried deep inside the subconscious mind. The Inner World lets us get to those valuable tools.

For personal change to happen, we need those tools in the subconscious to build good habits and break bad ones.

And more interestingly, we can use the same tools to redesign our personality and redefine the patterns of our behavior. These deep changes can only happen inside the subconscious mind. And they will bubble up to the conscious mind once the change is complete.

Permanent changes in behavior do not happen consciously. In fact, it's better to bypass the conscious mind—because it will only get in the way.

And the Inner World technique helps us do that—to bypass the conscious and leave the subconscious to work its magic on its own.

Got all that?

If not, don't worry. Here's the "*Explain To Me Like I'm Five (ELI5)*" version of the above—

1. The mind is mostly subconscious.

2. The subconscious mind gives us powerful tools for personal change.

3. The Inner World is the path to the subconscious mind.

Easy, right?

Good. Now, let's bring it all home and tie everything with social influence and persuasion; i.e. the rest of Shogun Method X.

INDOCTRINATION & THE INNER WORLD

Let's put on our Shogun Method hat and look at the Inner World theory from the perspective of the Shogun.

So, the ELI5 above becomes—

1. Your mark's mind is mostly subconscious.

2. The subconscious mind gives you powerful tools to indoctrinate the mark.

3. The Inner World is the path to the subconscious mind.

Your task, therefore, is to direct your mark's consciousness inwardly, leading him into his Inner World.

Most of your mark's individuality is shaped subconsciously. To *indoctrinate*¹² him, the change must happen subconsciously.

The Anzai Protocol shows you how to bypass the mark's conscious mind, access his subconscious and indoctrinate him in four steps (via the ARCI Sequence).

¹² Indoctrination is the higher persuasion. See the next chapter.

Can you see how this differs from conventional persuasion?

Cialdinian¹³ tactics like scarcity, likeability and authority deals with the Outer World, engaging the conscious mind. Nothing changes beyond the particular moment or transaction when the Cialdinian tactic is used. (This explains why the effect of those persuasion tactics is temporary.)

When someone undergoes indoctrination, however, his identity changes. And this change can only happen at the subconscious level, accessed through his Inner World.

¹³ A Cialdinian is someone who adheres to the mainstream persuasion school of thought, notably the teachings of Robert Cialdini.

The ARCI Sequence charts the path for you to navigate your mark's Inner World. With his compliance (remember, you don't rob him of his free will), you will craft his new identity. And via the four steps inside the ARCI Sequence, you will exploit his memories and experiences, crafting a new narrative that strengthens his new identity.

What's the ARCI Sequence?

Let's find out. Continue with the final chapter of Shogun Method X.

CHAPTER X

INDOCTRINATION

Indoctrinate. Don't persuade.

That seems strange, given that I wrote this book on the premise of using Shogun Method to persuade people. What's going on here?

Let me explain.

Like to many others, Derek Rake's Shogun Method changed my worldview. Examining sexual relationships from the female psychology angle yielded many surprising insights. That sexual bond is forged not by attraction but by mutual emotive dependency. That love and hate are but the manifestations of the same emotion. That pain intensifies pleasure; indeed, to the female mind, pain *is* pleasure.

Enslave. Don't seduce.

Shogun Method X proves the *fractality* of Shogun Method; what works on a woman works on anyone. After all, love is persuasion, perhaps its highest form. You are persuading someone to invest her emotions in you. A woman's emotions are her most precious commodity.

**As Derek Rake has demonstrated in his *oeuvre*,
seduction is a fallacy. And as I will show you, over my own
body of work, persuasion is a fallacy.**

Powerful men don't persuade. They indoctrinate.

Persuasion? Indoctrination? What's the difference?

There are a few. And the biggest difference is this—

**Persuasion is tied to the occasion. It's situational. It's
momentous. It's transactional. You're telling your mark: *do
this for me, one time.***

**Indoctrination lasts longer. Done correctly, it may even
last forever. Indoctrinate your mark once and he may obey
you for perpetuity.**

**If the devotion of a woman is what you want,
emotional enslavement is the endgame.**

**If power, influence and preeminence are what you
want, indoctrination is the endgame.**

THREE REQUISITES FOR INDOCTRINATION

**Unlike mainstream persuasion, there are no
silver bullets in indoctrination. There are no tactics
or tricks that will indoctrinate a person in minutes or
hours.**

Like Shogun Method, indoctrination is a multi-step process. There is a sequence to follow, with one stage preceding another in a linear fashion (i.e. the IRAE Model).

The similarity with Shogun Method does not end there. The Shogun has to fulfil certain *preconditions* to make emotional enslavement possible. In the same vein, there requisite conditions necessary for indoctrination—

Requisite #1: The Embrace of the Dark Side

Indoctrination requires a hearty dollop of cold-heartedness. Softies never bend the world to their will. Pragmatic ruthlessness is necessary.

Requisite #2: The Masking of Intent

Never expose your intentions. Like Shogun Method, covertness is the way. *Smile at your mark with a knife behind your back.*

Requisite #3: The Rendering of Justice

Don't inflict harm on your mark. Except it's to defend yourself, or if he deserves it. Render your mark his just due, nothing more, nothing less.

THE ARCI SEQUENCE

The ARCI (*ark-eye*) Sequence is the bedrock of indoctrination. It maps the four stages to increasing your mark's submission to your authority.

- **Stage One (the A stage): Capture Attention**
- **Stage Two (the R stage): Develop Rapport**
- **Stage Three (the C stage): Build Compliance**
- **Stage Four (the I stage): Perform Indoctrination**

Like the IRAE Model inside Shogun Method, the ARCI Sequence obeys the rule of the straight line. The Indoctrinator must complete one stage before moving to the next.

The first step is to capture your mark's attention (*stage one*). Directing his focus on you, develop rapport with him (*stage two*). With rapport, build up his compliance levels with a series of simple requests (*stage three*). Solidifying his compliance into habit, complete the sequence by indoctrinating him (*stage four*).

Skipping steps violates the straight line rule.

You can't build rapport with your mark without his attention.

You can't force your mark's compliance without rapport.

You can't indoctrinate your mark without compliance.

Attention. Rapport. Compliance. Indoctrination.
One step at a time. *In that order.*

And as you've seen in the IRAE Model, the straight line rule has a huge benefit—*you only need to take one step at a time.*

Your *modus operandi* as the Indoctrinator is as simple as it gets—

- **First, know which stage your mark is in the ARCI Sequence.**
- **Second, move him to the next stage with the tactics relevant *only* to that ARCI stage.**

INDOCTRINATION vs MAINSTREAM PERSUASION

Seasoned military strategists know this. Occupying the high ground confers an army with an unmatched strategic advantage.

It is on the higher grounds that the general gets an unblocked view of the entire battlefield. He is not interested in winning single battles. He is interested in winning the war.

Mainstream persuasion teaches you piecemeal tricks, tactics that work under very specific circumstances. With mainstream persuasion, you're focused on winning single battles. With mainstream persuasion, you forget about the bigger war.

Huge mistake.

Robert Greene asks in *The 33 Strategies of War*—do you exist in tactical hell or strategic heaven?

Mainstream persuasion plunges you into tactical hell. Indoctrination-based thinking elevates you to strategic heaven.

Being strategic (and not tactical) is the difference between success and failure. With a clear strategy, you're occupying the high ground above the battlefield. You know what the end goal is, and you view each battle as advancement towards that goal. You are not as concerned with the actual skirmish as you are with getting ahead.

The ARCI Sequence is that strategy.

SUMMARY

Shogun Method's notion of enslavement, not seduction shook me to the core.

But what surprised me was the parallel conclusion I came to about influence and social power-

Indoctrination, not persuasion.

Persuasion is tactical, not strategic. Persuasion happens piecemeal; you persuade one person at a time, again and again. It's repetitive. It's slow. It's hit-or-miss.

For mass control, there is but one way, and it's through indoctrination.

Indoctrinate. Don't persuade.

SELECT RESOURCES

THE ANZAI PROTOCOL

The Anzai Protocol is unfair knowledge for an unfair advantage in an unfair world.

Some men use this knowledge to get ahead. Others use it for self-defense. The wisest of the lot? They do both.

Look. It's an ugly fact of life that the strong will always feed on the weak. Are you the hunter or the prey?

You decide

SAIMIN-JUTSU

Self-hypnosis is one of the most overlooked male self-improvement techniques there is. Zan Azahiro's Saimin-Jutsu allows you to hypnotize yourself in eight minutes.

Activate your inner calm, confidence and charisma with ZenActivator. The Saimin-Jutsu is a great starting point to explore the ZenActivator universe.

This program is free for Shoguns. Offer expires when fully redeemed.

[Click here to redeem.](#)

DARK SPIRITUALITY

This knowledge is reserved for men who want power and control by exploring the dark side of their masculinity. We will show you how to exploit your darker traits to get ahead in life.

Because of the nature of this information, access is granted only to those who qualify.

Co-written by Akira Anzai and Derek Rake. If you loved Shogun Method X, you'll love Dark Spirituality.

[Apply for access](#)

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